When we finally got the doors shut and locked, we headed straight to Madison Square Garden and a Spice Girls concert. I hadn't really organized things properly, so I didn't even know how to get in to the place. We arrived outside and I was wandering around, looking for a stage door, until I spotted one of the tour managers. He took me inside and we set off down this corridor towards the Girls' dressing rooms.

Then the strangest thing happened: we were walking along and Victoria came the other way and walked straight past. She didn't recognize me: I had this big jacket on and a hat pulled low down on my head after the craziness at the airport. She hadn't been expecting me to get there so early and it was one of those moments when it takes a couple of beats to realize what has just happened. I turned round and she came running back. I just held onto her and didn't want to let go. We went through to the dressing room and I said hello to the other girls. Then Victoria and I crept into this tiny shower room and she showed me the scan of our new baby. It was just amazing. It was like a little pea on the picture: the scan was taken much earlier than the ones you're allowed to see in England. I was tingling with excitement. Any father will tell you, you can't imagine that feeling until it happens.

We went back to see the Girls and suddenly they were hugging and kissing me. I could hardly take it all in.

'Oh, I meant to say. Someone's coming in to meet us all in a minute,' said Victoria.

And in walked Madonna. She sat down and started chatting to Victoria and the other girls, while I just kept quiet and tried to make sure my mouth wasn't hanging open. Then she turned to me:

'Oh, you're the soccer player, aren't you?'

How did Madonna know who I was? I can't say I wasn't a bit pleased about that. As far as replying was concerned, I was dumbstruck. Madonna's just spoken to me, like she knows me. It was one of those situations where you're sure that, whatever you say, it's going to come out sounding stupid.

'Yes.'

It was time for the Girls to go on stage. The concert was absolutely fantastic. The Spice Girls were always great on stage: the energy, the color, the talent and the hard work, all of it shone through. Over the next twelve days, I turned into the Spice Girls' number one groupie. It wasn't the most